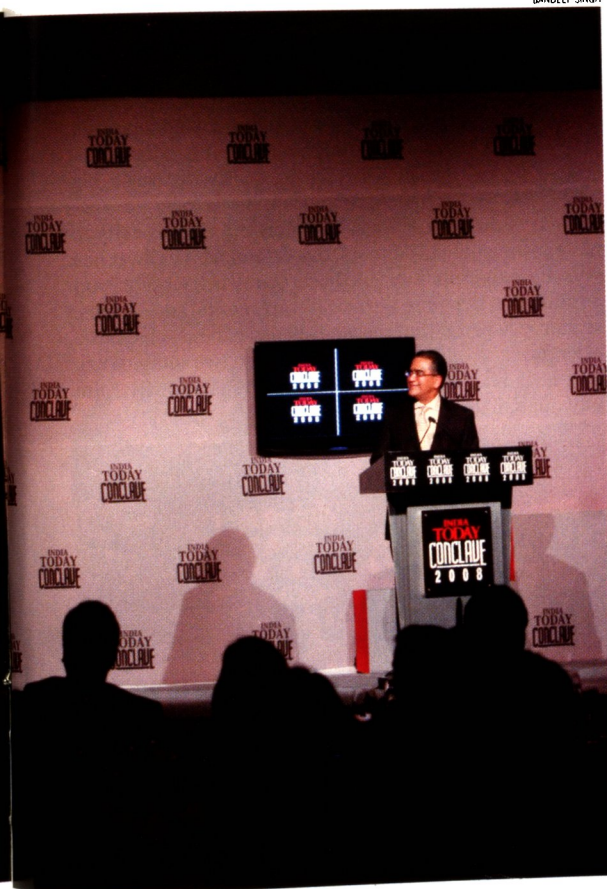


the inequality in the world. Working with indispensable partners in India, the William J. Clinton Foundation has arranged to provide the world's least expensive high-quality AIDS medicine to adolescent children all over the world. Another big problem in the developing world with regard to healthcare is the absence of systems. We find this in health, education and economic development.

Today half of the world's people live on less than two dollars a day, and a billion on less than a dollar a day. Largely it is not because they are not intelligent and not because they are incapable of learning things. It is because they do not have access to systems, the kind of systems we take for

BANDEEP SINGH



problem. I do not believe it will be addressed unless we can prove that we can change our energy patterns and essentially move into a post-common future. If we cannot prove that we can change the pattern of energy usage in a way that is good economics, then I don't think anything we do in America, Europe and Japan will make any difference. I think the planet will be irrevocably damaged by the middle of the century and our children and grandchildren will live a much reduced life. So the question is can we do this? And the answer is nobody knows for sure. But, I think we can. And I devote a lot of my time now to working with cities around the world proving that there are things that we can do on energy, on water management that will make a real difference and actually boost economic growth. Our climate change initiatives work with 40 cities across six continents to prove that it is good economics over the long run to save the planet for our children and grandchildren. We are working in Delhi and Mumbai in India, primarily on building efficiency, trying to cut energy usage and clean the environment in that way. But over the long run, there are lots of other things that have to be done. We are working on water management systems—it is a huge issue in Delhi and we are hoping we can help improve waste management systems in a way that improves the energy situation, public health and the quality of life.

I believe that India has enormous potential in solar energy, in wind energy and in tidal energy to build a clear energy future, to build an efficient future and to find jobs for a lot of people in smaller areas and in rural areas from where a lot of people are coming to the big cities without sufficient employment. If you think about it, changing India's energy future will actually compliment the high-tech sources of economic growth you have had in the last few years and broaden economic opportunity. The current Government in India, after all, was elected after the country

had enjoyed 9 per cent growth for several years. But it had been largely confined to 35 per cent of the population. The government's commitment was to spread that growth to the other 65 per cent. The easiest way to do that is by changing the way you generate energy, by localising it, by making the country more energy independent and by using

"THE NGO SYSTEM, MORE INFLUENTIAL THAN EVER BEFORE, CAN EMPOWER PEOPLE TO FIND BETTER LOCALISED SOLUTIONS."

Bill Clinton

granted and which make generation of wealth possible, make comfortable lives possible, make building blocks of a good life possible in terms of health and education and shelter. So my foundation does a lot of work to have those systems and I am convinced that one of the most important things a non-governmental system can do is to empower people at the local level to create their own systems.

Finally, let me just say a word about the sustainability issue. I believe that global warming is a real and persistent

the matters at hand, using the sun, using the wind, using the tidal energy along the coast, particularly in the Indian Ocean where the tides are quite strong, and by maximising energy efficiency—in lighting, in heating, in building material. There are all kinds of things that can be done and there are millions and millions of jobs to be created in doing it.

Now you can't tell people not to use coal. Therefore, we will have to find a way to take the carbondioxide out of the coal and either burn it up or put it underground.